



UNSW Global
AUSTRALIA

PAPER C



2015 ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

WRITING

PERSUASIVE WRITING

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

TIME ALLOWED: 30 MINUTES

5 minutes reading and planning time

20 minutes writing time

5 minutes checking time

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER BOOKLET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Educational Assessment Australia
eaa.unsw.edu.au

REVIEW

A book review has several purposes. It gives readers an idea of what the book is about and an opinion of the book. It also explains why the book may or may not be good to read.

Read the following book review.

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying <http://www.eaalibrary.edu.au>. The website has a yellow header with navigation buttons: HOME, NEW ARRIVAL, BUY ONLINE, and MAGAZINES. A search bar labeled 'SEARCH LIBRARY' is on the right. Below the header, a red banner reads 'JUST ARRIVED IN THE LIBRARY'. The main content area has a light blue background and features a book review for *Big Day Out* by Jennifer Liu. The review text describes the book as a modern detective story combining adventure and science fiction, featuring a digital character named Max. It mentions that the book is enjoyable for young readers and provides a brief plot summary. The browser's status bar at the bottom shows 'Internet'.

JUST ARRIVED IN THE LIBRARY

Big Day Out by Jennifer Liu

Jennifer Liu's latest novel, *Big Day Out*, combines adventure with science fiction in an inventive way. Two young children team up with Max, a digital character, for a series of unusual adventures in this *Cam Jansen-meets-Minecraft* modern detective story.

Max enjoys his life as a character in a children's computer game. Most of his time is spent building and destroying things. One day a system error ejects him from his cyber world and he lands in the bedroom of Henry and Grace, the children playing the game. They help him investigate how and why he was ejected. Max finds that it is trickier to deal with humans than digital characters, so he appreciates the help of his new friends. After some mistakes and lots of clever detective work, Henry and Grace help Max return home.

Big Day Out is an enjoyable read. Young readers will be able to imagine themselves as Henry or Grace. The author skilfully develops Max into a believable character. For example, Max only uses 'tech talk' in the beginning but he quickly learns from Henry and Grace how to communicate with humans. This book is so interesting that you might need to hide it from your older brother or sister!

Reviewers choose language which suits what they are reviewing. This reviewer has used words which

- describe the type of book it is e.g. *combines adventure with science fiction, modern detective story*
- appeal to people who will want to read the book e.g. *digital character, imagine themselves as Henry or Grace*
- refer to similar books e.g. *Cam Jansen-meets-Minecraft*.

WRITING TASK

Write a book review that could be published on your school's website.

You can review any kind of book such as a picture book, a novel or a non-fiction (information) book. The book does not have to be real.

- Tell readers what type of book it is and who might enjoy it.
- Briefly describe what the book is about and your feelings about it.
- Provide a recommendation about whether the book is worth reading. Give reasons for your opinion.

HINTS

- Use the planning time to organise your ideas.
- Stay on the topic: **Write a book review that could be published on your school's website.** Remember that you can review any kind of book.
- Choose interesting words to describe the book and to explain your feelings about it.
- Use different types of sentences to make your review interesting.
- Make sure you use correct grammar, spelling and punctuation.
- Write only on the lines provided. Additional writing may not be marked.
- Use the time at the end of the task to check and improve your writing.